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We have been saying repeatedly that the western countries accounted for a large share of the carbon emissions responsible for raising the earth's temperature. The world can be saved by only two things. First, the right technology should be transferred to all the developing countries. Second, finance should be made available to them to adopt the technology. Developed countries have a responsibility, and more than that they have their own commitments made at the COP of providing \$100 billion. Some years ago, a report said developing countries need a minimum of \$5 trillion to combat climate change.

Q: US has gone back on its climate commitments. How do you think this will impact the developing world?

A: We are part of the global climate change negotiations. We always tell the developed countries that the progress they have made in this century has been at the cost of developing countries. Climate finance is their commitment, and they should honour it. As far as India is concerned, we are not disappointed because we follow the vision of Prime Minister Narendra Modi that India will become a part of the solution regarding climate in the world. It will not become a part of the problem.

Q: Can self-reliance save the country from the need for finance and technology?

A: All the adaptation programmes we have run till now have been operated with domestic resources. Even the capacity that we have acquired in renewables, we have built with domestic resources. Besides, there are other measures that we are taking. In the last Union Budget, the government proposed building small modular nuclear power plants. That is yet another step forward in the direction of mitigation.

We achieved our NDC target, we also announced a target of achieving net-zero emissions by 2070. India is growing with such determination that today we have become the fourth-largest economy under the

“Be it our vehicles, industry, or refrigerator, they do emit pollutants. In such a situation, whoever invents the technology or profits from it has a social responsibility”